

Guidance from US Department of Education

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Application for Title IV Approval of a Comprehensive Transition and Postsecondary Program

If an institution wishes to have a Comprehensive Transition and Postsecondary (CTP) Program determined to be an eligible program for the Federal Pell Grant, FSEOG, and FWS programs, it must submit an updated Electronic Application for Approval to Participate in the Title IV Federal Student Aid Programs (E-App) to the Department (34 CFR 600.20). The E-App can be accessed at <https://fsapartners.ed.gov/home/>. After submitting the electronic application, the institution must mail the signed signature page to the Department and submit, via email, a detailed description of the program, as described below, along with any other requested supporting documentation.

The detailed description, not to exceed thirty pages, should indicate how the program meets all of the definitional components of a CTP Program, as outlined in item (1), below, as well as the additional program eligibility components outlined in (2) through (5) below.

- (1) (a) The Comprehensive Transition and Postsecondary Program is delivered to students physically attending the institution, but may include off-campus activities;
- (b) The Comprehensive Transition and Postsecondary Program is designed to support students with intellectual disabilities who are seeking to continue academic, career and technical, and independent living instruction at an institution of higher education in order to prepare for employment;
- (c) The Comprehensive Transition and Postsecondary Program includes an advising and curriculum structure;
- (d) The Comprehensive Transition and Postsecondary Program requires students with intellectual disabilities to have at least one-half of their participation in the program, as determined by the institution, focus on academic components through one or more of the following activities:
 - (i) Taking credit-bearing courses with students without disabilities;
 - (ii) Auditing or otherwise participating in courses with students without disabilities for which the student does not receive regular academic credit;
 - (iii) Taking non-credit-bearing, nondegree courses with students without disabilities;
 - (iv) Participating in internships or work-based training in settings with individuals without disabilities; and
- (e) The Comprehensive Transition and Postsecondary Program provides students with intellectual disabilities opportunities to be socially and academically integrated with non-disabled students to the maximum extent possible.

- (2) The institutional policy for determining whether a student enrolled in the program is making satisfactory academic progress;
- (3) The number of weeks of instructional time and the number of semester or quarter credit hours or clock hours in the program, including the equivalent credit or clock hours associated with noncredit or reduced credit courses or activities;
- (4) A description of the educational credential offered (e.g., degree or certificate) or identified outcome or outcomes established by the institution for all students enrolled in the;
- (5) A copy of the letter or notice sent to the institution's accrediting agency informing the agency of its Comprehensive Transition and Postsecondary Program. The letter or notice must include a description of the items in paragraphs (1) through (4) of this section.

Application Process Overview

The Department accepts applications for approval online and on a rolling basis. Institutional applications will be reviewed by the Department to ensure that the application is properly completed, to determine whether the institution can be considered for adding an additional program, and to determine whether the program meets basic Title IV eligibility requirements.

The detailed information about the institution's CTP Program will be reviewed by an independent panel of Field Reviewers, who will offer recommendations to the Department regarding the program's alignment with the regulatory requirements for these programs. It is imperative that the financial aid administrator and the program administrator communicate to ensure that all of the required elements are included in the application. Otherwise, the Department may need to contact the institution to ascertain or clarify information to facilitate the review of the application, delaying the program's approval.

Applicants are encouraged to provide evidence of how their program aligns with each of the elements described above. For example, institutions may want to submit course syllabi, catalogue descriptions, informational materials, recruitment bulletins, and assessment protocols. Any additional information submitted by an institution will count toward the thirty-page limit.

As with all other eligible programs, institutions must reapply to the Department when the program changes. Examples that could warrant reapplication include: changes in course sequence or content, changes in the length of time that students take to fulfill the program requirements, and changes in the educational credential offered.

Please note that applicants must include the names and contact information of the institutional program contact or other institutional contact who can answer specific questions about the CTP program.

Accreditation

It is anticipated that, over time, institutional accreditors will include the CTP Program within the scope of the institutional accreditation review process. Information that the institution receives from the accrediting agency should be included in the initial and any reapplication to the Department.

Student Eligibility

Institutions must obtain documentation substantiating that the student meets the definition of a “student with an intellectual disability,” as defined in 34 CFR 668.231. That documentation must demonstrate both that the student has an intellectual disability and that they are or were formerly eligible to receive special education and related services under the Individual with Disabilities Education Act (IDEA).

This requirement may be satisfied by a record from a local educational agency indicating that the student is or was eligible for special education and related services under IDEA and that the student has an intellectual disability. If that record does not specifically identify the student as having a specific intellectual disability, the institution must obtain additional documentation that the student has an intellectual disability, such as:

- (1) A documented, comprehensive, and individualized evaluation and diagnosis of an intellectual disability by a psychologist or other qualified professional, or
- (2) A record of the disability from a local or State educational agency or government agency that identifies the intellectual disability.

Furthermore, Title IV funds may only be awarded to students who meet the general student eligibility requirements for Title IV programs provided in 34 CFR 668.31 except for the requirements in 34 CFR 668.32(a), (e), and (f). With regard to these requirements, a student in each CTP Program:

- (1) Need not be enrolled in a program that leads to a degree or certificate;
- (2) Need not possess a high school diploma, a recognized equivalent of a high school diploma, or have passed an approved ability to benefit test; and
- (3) Must be making satisfactory academic progress according to the institution’s published standards for students enrolled in its CTP Programs; however, the satisfactory academic progress policy may be different for students enrolled in CTP Programs than the policy that governs the rest of the student body.

If you have questions about the application process for CTP Programs, contact the [School Participation Section](#) of FSA.